

FLOMASTER

USER GUIDE

V2.4 - WINDOWS 10/11

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FLOMASTER is a launcher for 3D graphics applications: one button starts Blender, Maya, Houdini, Nuke, DaVinci Resolve, Unreal Engine or Substance Painter with a predefined OCIO color config. The launcher finds installed applications automatically, keeps launch presets and profiles, opens project files, runs from the command line and logs every launch. One color config - across all applications, with no manual environment setup.

github.com/abyrvalg379/FLOMASTER

CONTENTS

1. About FLOMASTER.....	3
2. Installation and updates.....	3
3. Quick start.....	3
4. Presets and auto-scan.....	3
5. Launch profiles.....	4
6. Projects panel.....	4
7. Project files.....	4
8. OCIO roles.....	4
9. How OCIO support works.....	5
10. Themes and the window chrome.....	5
11. Settings.....	5
12. Tray and log.....	6
13. Command line.....	6
14. Moving to another machine.....	6
15. Files and folders.....	7
16. Workflows.....	7
17. Troubleshooting.....	7

1. ABOUT FLOMASTER

Key features:

- auto-scan of installed applications from the Windows registry, Epic Games manifests and file search — Blender, K-Cycles, Maya, Houdini, Nuke, DaVinci Resolve, Unreal Engine, Substance Painter;
- launch presets: your own name, exe and launch arguments;
- launch profiles: named app + OCIO config + arguments bundles, one-click project switching;
- Projects panel: a project file browser over your own folders, opening files right in the launcher;
- OCIO roles: per-preset role overrides without touching the config;
- a command line for batch files and farms;
- settings transfer between machines via a file;
- 7 color themes including the window title bar, and a global Ctrl+Alt+F hotkey;
- system tray with quick launch of presets and profiles;
- launch log and auto-update from GitHub.

2. INSTALLATION AND UPDATES

- Download the latest release: github.com/abyrvalg379/FLOMASTER → Releases → Latest.
- Extract the archive to a folder of your choice (e.g. C:\Program Files\FLOMASTER).
- Run FLOMASTER.exe. The build is self-contained: .NET 8 is bundled, nothing else to install.
- The window opens in the top-right corner of the screen. User data (settings and the log) is created in %APPDATA%\FLOMASTER\.
- Auto-update: on start the launcher checks GitHub for a new version, downloads it in the background and shows a "Restart and install" button in Settings — one click, one UAC prompt. Disable it with the Check for updates on start checkbox.
- Manual update: close the launcher (including the tray), replace the files, start it again. Settings and the log live apart from the program and survive updates.

3. QUICK START

- Start FLOMASTER — the auto-scan finds installed applications.
- Pick an application in the APPLICATION list and click Launch — it starts with the OCIO config.
- Check the color spaces in the application (in Blender — the Color Management tab in scene properties).
- Expand the Projects panel, add a project folder with the "+" button and open a file with a click — it starts in the selected application.
- Press Save current as profile in the Profiles panel — the current app + config + arguments bundle is saved under a name.
- Ctrl+Alt+F hides and restores the launcher above any application.

4. PRESETS AND AUTO-SCAN

4.1 Auto-scan

On start the launcher looks for installed applications: first in the Windows registry and Epic Games Launcher manifests, then by file search in standard locations. Something installed in a non-standard folder (portable builds, custom versions)? Add the folder in Settings → Scan paths and the card appears on the next scan.

4.2 Custom presets

A preset is a pair of "name + path to exe". Two ways to create one:

- drag the application exe right into the launcher window - you will be asked for a name;
- create a preset manually and point it to the exe.

Each preset carries its own launch arguments (the Quick commands panel) - that is how you keep several versions of one application or special launch keys.

5. LAUNCH PROFILES

A profile is a named snapshot of a launch state: application + OCIO config + arguments. It is the unit of task switching: "Project A" and "Project B" differ by one click instead of re-tuning three fields.

- set the application, OCIO config and arguments, expand the Profiles panel and press Save current as profile;
- clicking a profile restores the whole bundle (profiles reference the preset and config by name — edits are picked up);
- the cross deletes a profile (with confirmation);
- the tray menu has a PROFILES section — launch a profile straight from the tray, no window needed.

A typical set: one profile per project (different OCIO configs), one per application version, one for background rendering (bake arguments). Profiles travel between machines with your settings — see "Moving to another machine".

6. PROJECTS PANEL

The Projects panel is a project file browser inside the launcher: instead of digging through the file manager you open the file you need with one click.

- add the folder where your projects live with the "+" button (a root); "-" removes the selected root;
- expand the Projects panel: the list shows every project file under the root recursively, with relative paths;
- the search field filters the list by file name;
- clicking a file opens it with the current application, OCIO config applied, and adds it to Recent.

Only native DCC formats are listed: .blend, .spp, .ma, .mb, .hip, .hipl, .hipnc, .nk. Export formats (.fbx, .obj, .stl) are deliberately hidden — those are exports, not projects.

7. PROJECT FILES

Drag a project file onto the launcher window — it opens in the selected application with the OCIO config applied. The same files are available in the Recent list — a click reopens them without the file manager. Supported: .blend, .spp, .ma, .mb, .hip, .hipl, .hipnc, .nk.

8. OCIO ROLES

The Roles panel shows what the key color roles of the selected config resolve to (scene_linear, data, default_byte and others) — and lets you override them per preset.

- clicking a role row opens the picker: colorspaces grouped by family, like the Color Space menu in Blender, with search;
- overrides are stored in the launcher config, and a derived config is built at launch — the original .ocio file is never modified;

- Reset returns all roles of the preset to the config values;
- under the config selector a validation line highlights missing critical roles and broken references in advance.

9. HOW OCIO SUPPORT WORKS

Most applications read the config path from the OCIO environment variable - the launcher sets it on launch. Unreal Engine ignores the variable: it receives the path as a `-ocio="path"` argument - the launcher does that for you.

APPLICATION	METHOD
Blender, Maya, Houdini, Nuke, DaVinci Resolve, Substance Painter	OCIO environment variable
Unreal Engine	-ocio= argument

The bundled ACES 1.2 config (the ocio/ folder next to the exe) defines lowercase aliases `acescg` and `raw`: interchange ACES names identical across applications and configs. Scripts and presets that set a colorspace by the `acescg` or `raw` string survive config changes - long names like "ACES - ACEScg" are unique to one config. The transforms behind an alias and its long name are identical.

Default roles in the bundled config are tuned for a typical texture cycle: 8-bit images open as `raw`, float images (`EXR`) - as `acescg`.

10. THEMES AND THE WINDOW CHROME

Seven color schemes - one per application in the pipeline. Switch the theme in Settings; the entire interface follows: buttons, checkboxes, the scrollbar, dropdown menus, the window title strip and the Launch button hover state.

THEME	ACCENT	BASE
Blender	orange	dark graphite
Maya	cyan	blue-gray
Houdini	red-orange	dark (sampled from the real UI)
Nuke	light gray	graphite, monochrome
DaVinci	pink-red	purple-navy
Unreal	blue	cool graphite
Substance	green	black

The title strip is drawn by the launcher itself, in the theme colors: the application name on the left, minimize and close buttons on the right. Drag the window by the strip.

11. SETTINGS

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Check for updates on start	auto-update check at launch
Theme	interface color theme
Start with Windows	auto-start minimized to tray with Windows

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Always on top	window above all others
Smooth animation	enable/disable panel animation
Global hotkey (Ctrl+Alt+F)	global hotkey: show/hide the launcher above everything
Default OCIO	default config for tray launches
Scan paths	extra folders for the auto-scan
SYNC	export/import settings to move them to another machine
Shortcuts	Start Menu and desktop shortcuts

12. TRAY AND LOG

Closing the window minimizes the launcher to the system tray - it keeps running. The tray menu offers quick launch of presets, a PROFILES section (one-click profile launches) and the window itself.

The Log button opens the log window beside the launcher (same height, to the left or right - wherever it fits). Every launch is logged: timestamp, user, application, OCIO config, exit code. A "Set OCIO=..." line marks that the config was actually passed. The log file lives at %APPDATA%\FLOMASTER\flomaster.log.

13. COMMAND LINE

The launcher runs without a window - for batch files, farms and scripts:

```
FLOMASTER.exe --list-profiles
```

```
FLOMASTER.exe --launch "Profile"
```

```
FLOMASTER.exe --launch "Profile" --project "D:\projects\A\shot_042.blend"
```

A profile resolves to application + OCIO config + arguments - the same environment as a manual launch. --project appends the file to the profile arguments (or substitutes the {file} placeholder if the profile has one).

EXIT CODE	MEANING
0	launched successfully
1	launch or usage error
2	profile, preset or project file not found

Output goes to the console the exe was started from. Environment variables and OCIO are passed exactly like a window launch.

14. MOVING TO ANOTHER MACHINE

Settings travel as a file: Settings → SYNC → Export settings saves profiles, project roots, theme and options into a flomaster_setup_date.flomaster file. On another machine: install the launcher, press Import settings and pick the file.

- profiles are imported by name: new ones are added, existing ones updated;
- project roots merge without duplicates;
- exe paths stay machine-local: presets match by name, so after importing check that applications are found (Rescan);

The auto-scan on a fresh machine picks up installed applications from the registry and Epic manifests — as a rule, presets assemble themselves.

15. FILES AND FOLDERS

PATH	CONTENTS
installation folder	FLOMASTER.exe, flomaster.ico, ocio/ (ACES 1.2 config + luts/), LICENSE.txt
%APPDATA%\FLOMASTER\	launcher_config.json (settings), flomaster.log (log), variants/ (per-role config variants)

The program and user data are deliberately separated: reinstalling and updating never touch settings, presets or the log.

16. WORKFLOWS

One color from the start of the day

Launcher window → Launch on the application you need. Everything you start that day runs on the same config - files travel between applications without color surprises.

Switching between projects

Set up one profile per project and switch them in the Profiles panel with a single click. From the tray a profile launches right away, without the launcher window.

Open a project file without leaving the task

Projects panel → root → click the file. Name search finds files deep inside folders.

Textures: what opens and where

Float images (EXR) open as acescg - the color cycle is correct right away. 8-bit images open as raw: the right default for data maps (normals, masks, roughness) with no manual clicks. Assign a colorspace manually to a color 8-bit map if it opened as raw.

Background render from a batch file

Save a profile with bake arguments and run: FLOMASTER.exe --launch "Render" --project "scene.blend". Exit code 0 — the process is on its way.

Several versions of one application

Create one preset per version (drag the exe + name) and start the one you need with a click; the version arguments live in the preset Quick commands.

17. TROUBLESHOOTING

SYMPTOM	CAUSE	WHAT TO DO
Application missing after installation	non-standard install folder	add the folder in Settings → Scan paths or create a preset by dragging the exe

SYMPTOM	CAUSE	WHAT TO DO
Ctrl+Alt+F does nothing	the combination is taken by another application	check for a warn line in the log; free the combination or toggle the Global hotkey checkbox off and on
Profile does not start from the command line, exit code 2	profile/preset/file not found	check the profile name with --list-profiles; presets match by name
Project file is not visible in the Projects panel	only native DCC formats are listed (.blend, .spp, .ma, .mb, .hip, .hipl, .hipnc, .nk)	use name search or drag the file into the window directly
Unreal started with the wrong color	Unreal does not read the OCIO variable	keep the -ocio= argument in the preset arguments - that is how the launcher passes the config
Error «enum "Non-Color" not found» on import	the bundled config has no colorspace named Non-Color (the raw alias exists)	import outside this OCIO config, or add a colorspace/alias with that name to the config
A color 8-bit map opened as raw	the default_byte role in the config is raw (the default for data maps)	assign a colorspace manually to that map: sRGB space for 8-bit color, acescg for float
Log window is nowhere to be seen	it opens beside the launcher, at the same height	look to the left/right of the launcher window
Settings and log "disappeared" after reinstall	they do not live in the program folder	look in %APPDATA%\FLOMASTER\ - updates never touch them
After moving settings the presets point to wrong places	exe paths are machine-specific and are not exported	run Rescan on the new machine — presets will be found in the registry